▼ GLASSHOUSE



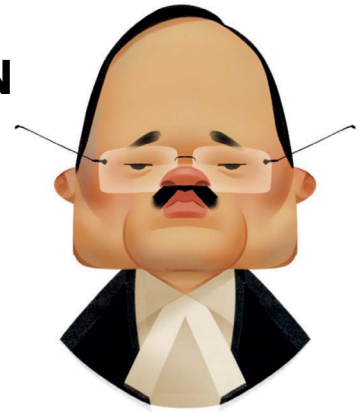
LOYALTY BONUS

Hard work does pay. In choosing Congress candidates for the June 18 Rajya Sabha election, **Rahul Gandhi** and **Mallikarjun Kharge** ensured loyalists get their due. So, long-time Rahul associate, Praveen Chakravarty (head of the data wing) has been fielded from Tamil Nadu. An early convert to the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam's cause, he benefited after Vijay's TVK gave up its lone RS seat for the Congress. AICC secretary Mansoor Ali Khan (from Karnataka) was rewarded for his work in Telangana and Kerala, where the party is back in power, while media cell head Pawan Khera (Rajasthan) got the thumbs up for his attacks on Rahul's bete noire, Assam CM Himanta Biswa Sarma. Meenakshi Natarajan got the nod from MP, but her nomination was rejected. Kharge has backed his men too: communication in-charge Pranav Jha will contest from Jharkhand, and Neeraj Dangi for a second term from Rajasthan.

Illustrations by **SIDDHANT JUMDE**

▼ NEW ROACH APPROACH

COURT CORRECTION



Chief Justice of India **Surya Kant** seems to have made a careful course correction. On May 15, his "cockroaches" remark unleashed a storm—the comment was read by many as an attack on India's youth, though the CJI clarified the next day that he was referring only to those entering the lawyer profession with dubious qualifications. That note of moderation continued through June 6 when, in an address to the Oxford Union, the CJI praised-praised young lawyers and judicial officers as the force driving the judiciary's shift to technology. He said their comfort with digital courts, e-filing and AI-assisted research had made the system stronger and more efficient. He did add a caveat, though: technology must assist judges, not replace them. "The conscience, discretion and ethical reasoning of a judge cannot be coded into an algorithm," he warned.